

Goyal, CEO and MD, PLG Power.

RIM plans manufacturing in India

India might become an export hub for BlackBerry products as Canadian smartphone maker Research In Motion (RIM) plans to set up a manufacturing plant here.

According to a RIM spokesperson, India is an important and strategic market for the company and its fast-growing mobile sector offers a major potential for further expansion. As part of RIM's strategy in India, the company has been building its resources in order to support the growing opportunities.

HP to invest in new data centres

Hewlett-Packard (HP) plans to open two data centres in India with an investment of \$1 billion.

"We have just launched IT infrastructure-as-a-service in Australia. In the Asia-Pacific region, we are going to introduce the same in India, China and Singapore this year," said Braden Wondra, chief technology officer-enterprise services, APAC, HP.

The company would target big corporations for private cloud (services offered on the client's premises) and small and medium businesses for public cloud.

NDS to invest in R&D

NDS, a digital pay TV technology solutions provider, plans to invest \$400 million for R&D in India, which is likely to become its revenue grosser by 2015.

"India is set to overtake the US as the largest direct-to-home (DTH) market in the world this year. Besides, with the government taking initiatives to digitise the analogue cable base over the next few years, the potential for us is huge," said Jayant Changrani, country head, NDS India.

According to industry estimates, India will have 40 million DTH subscribers and around five million digital

Moser Baer completes first solar project

Moser Baer India has completed its first solar-window project aimed at producing electricity by laying solar panels on the exterior of a building in Hyderabad. The solar panels would produce electricity using thin-film silicon solar cells and have an installed capacity of 1.8 kilowatts.

Digi-Key drops printed catalogue

Digi-Key Corporation, a global electronic components distributor, will cease all print versions of its product catalogue, offering this content exclusively online. This all-digital decision, driven by the company's efforts to be environmentally vigilant, marks a major milestone in Digi-Key's transition into a totally integrated Internet-based distributor.

Matrix Comsec opens new R&D centre

Telecom and security product manufacturer Matrix Comsec has inaugurated an R&D centre in Vadodara. The new R&D centre is expected to house more than 500 design and development engineers, and will be the nucleus of the company's activities connecting its design, development and manufacturing activities with its global sales and marketing operations.

cable subscribers by the end of 2011. This would still leave a base of 80 million analogue households for digital TV service providers to tap into.

ROHM establishes sales company

Semiconductor manufacturer ROHM Co. has established ROHM Semiconductor India in Chennai. The new company, which will sell ROHM products in India, plans to open sales facilities in Delhi and Pune.

Sales of ROHM products in the region have previously been overseen by ROHM Semiconductor Singapore, with marketing and information-gathering support from a local ROHM office that opened in Chennai in February 2006. By establishing ROHM Semiconductor India, ROHM hopes to expand its share of the country's electronics market in sectors like on-board automotive, communications and home electronics.

Seagate buying Samsung's hard drive business

Samsung Electronics and Seagate Technology will expand and strengthen their strategic relationship by further aligning their respective ownership, investments and key technologies.

The major guidelines of the agree-

ment include extending and enhancing the existing patent cross-licence agreement between the companies. Samsung will combine its hard disk drive operations into Seagate. Also, under a NAND flash memory supply agreement, it will provide Seagate with its semiconductor products for use in the latter's enterprise solidstate drives, solidstate hybrid drives and other products.

Seagate will supply disk drives to Samsung for PCs, notebooks and consumer electronics. Also, an executive of Samsung will be nominated to join Seagate's board of directors under the shareholder agreement.

TI to buy National Semiconductor

Texas Instruments (TI) is set to buy National Semiconductor for \$6.5 billion. The move is claimed to be good for both the companies as their combined sales team will be ten times bigger than National Semiconductor's current sales force.

"This acquisition is about strength and growth. National has an excellent development team, and its products combined with our own can offer customers an analogue portfolio of unmatched depth and breadth," said Rich Templeton, CEO, TI.

Snippets